

Subject Code	ENGL4004
Subject Title	Effective Communication for Public Relations
Credit Value	3
Level	4
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	None
Objectives	• to develop linguistic skills relating to image building as applied to corporate communication. • to broaden the understanding of public relations in workplace
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. employ a range of techniques for effective public relations and promotion, and have extensive practice in oral skills suitable for use in the evolving technological landscape; b. exhibit confidence in public speaking when representing an organisation, considering the global implications of the messages; c. communicate effectively with the media, considering the need of mindful messaging in the online context for sustainable development; d. write text for public relations and promotional purposes that align with ethical standards and technological advancements, for example, creating various kinds of professional writing such as online news releases and media kits; e. display awareness of the importance of public relations in business and government organisations, emphasising integrity, and social responsibility; f. develop useful interpersonal skills for life-long career.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	1. the importance of organizational image projection 2. language usage in public relations 3. public speaking in relation to press conferences 4. written skills for press release
Teaching/ Learning Methodology	The course uses authentic commercial and public sector examples to illustrate key perspectives and concepts. Discussion activities and

	assignments are designed for students to put theories and ideas into practice.							
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed					
			a	b	c	d	e	f
	1. Public Speaking	25%	✓	✓	✓			✓
	2. Feature Article	30%	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	3. Press Release	20%	✓	✓		✓	✓	
	4. Press Conference	25%	✓	✓	✓		✓	✓
	Total	100%						
	The assessments are designed to build students’ confidence and provide practical communication techniques for effective public relations. 1. The public speaking assessment allows students to practice delivering messages confidently and gain hands-on experience. 2. The feature article helps students plan and craft a persuasive image-building campaign by selecting relevant brands and audiences, presenting information clearly and creatively, and using appropriate PR writing conventions. 3. The press release assesses student’s ability to apply appropriate media-focused structure and language to write in a professional and newsworthy manner. 4. The press conference develops students’ teamwork and communication skills by having them work in groups to deliver a cohesive message. Students learn to prepare for media engagement by developing key talking points, responding to questions professionally, and applying effective public relations strategies to shape public perception.							
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:							
	▪ Lecture						39 Hrs.	
	▪ Seminar						0 Hrs.	

	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Assignments & presentation preparations	30 Hrs.
	▪ Research & self-study	57 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	126 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Wilcox, D. L., & Reber, B. H. (2016). <i>Public relations writing and media techniques</i> (8th ed.). Pearson. Other valuable references Bivins, T. (2013). <i>Public relations writing: The essentials of style and form</i> (8th ed.). McGraw Hill. Davis, A. (2003). <i>Everything you should know about public relations: Direct answers to over 500 questions</i>. Kogan Page. Foster, J. (2012). <i>Writing skills for public relations: Style and technique for mainstream and social media</i> (5th ed.). Kogan Page. Green, A., & Chartered Institute of Public Relations. (2010). <i>Creativity in public relations</i> (4th ed.). Kogan Page. Gregory, A. (2021). <i>Planning and managing public relations campaigns: A strategic approach</i> (5th ed.). Kogan Page. Hendershot, A., Loewen, L., & Marsh, C. (2024). <i>Strategic writing: Multimedia writing for public relations, advertising and more</i> (6th ed.). Routledge. Henslowe, P. (2003). <i>Public relations: A practical guide to the basics</i> (2nd ed.). Kogan Page. Thompson, G. (2020). <i>Post-truth public relations: Communication in an era of digital disinformation</i>. Routledge.	

Revised by Amy Suen, May 2026